Business English

2025-2026

FILE 4

Conducting & Promoting a Business Online

2ème e-business

Equipe langues e-business

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Introductory vocabulary list

address customers' concerns/complaints	**traiter les préoccupations/plaintes des clients**
brick-and-mortar store / physical store	**magasin physique**
browse	**parcourir**
browse the internet	**naviguer sur Internet**
build trust	**instaurer la confiance**
Call to Action (CTA)	**appel à l'action (CTA)**
check out	**finaliser un achat, valider sa commande, procéder au paiement** **=** to confirm and pay for the items in your shopping cart.
complaints	**plaintes**
Cost Per Click (CPC)	**coût par clic (CPC)**
customer loyalty	**fidélité client**
customer support	**support client**
damage brand image	**nuire à l'image de marque**
delivery / shipping	**livraison**
discount / promo code	**reduction / code promo /**
drive traffic to a website	**générer du trafic vers un site web**
follow	**suivre**
follower	**abonné**
handle negative feedback	**gérer les retours négatifs**
improve search rankings	**améliorer le classement dans les moteurs de recherche**
item	**article**
landing page	**page de destination** = specific webpage where customers arrive after clicking on an advertisement, a promotional email or a social media link.
marketplace	**marketplace** = an online platform, like Amazon, Etsy, or Airbnb, where sellers offer products or services and buyers can browse, compare, and purchase them.
monitor	**surveiller**
online store/ online shop / webshop / web store / e-shop	**magasin en ligne**
order	**commander**
organic traffic	**trafic organique**

	= people who reach a website naturally, through search engines like Google, without clicking on ads.
packaging	**emballage**
paid traffic	**trafic payant**
payment method	**méthode de paiement**
post	**publier**
post / leave a positive review	**laisser un avis positif**
ratings	**évaluations, notes** = scores given by customers to a product, service or seller (usually as stars or numbers) to show quality to guide other buyers.
reach a large audience	**atteindre un large public**
refund **(a) refund**	**rembourser** **remboursement**
respond / reply to reviews	**répondre aux avis**
restore trust	**restaurer la confiance**
Return on Investment (ROI)	**retour sur investissement (ROI)**
return policy	**politique de retour**
run a paid campaign	**mener une campagne payante**
Search Engine Optimization (SEO)	**référencement naturel (SEO)**
Search Engine Advertising (SEA)	**référencement payant (SEA)**
share	**partager**
shopping cart	**panier d'achat**
sponsored ads	**annonces sponsorisées**
subscribe to a newsletter	**s'abonner à une newsletter**
target specific audiences	**cibler des audiences spécifiques**
user-friendly website	**site facile d'utilisation**
User-Generated Content (UGC)	**contenu généré par les utilisateurs**
visit a website	**consulter un site web**
website traffic	**trafic du site web**

1. Online reputation & digital marketing

Speaking – Introduction: Discuss the following questions in pairs.

1. What is online reputation? (try to explain with your own words)

2. Why is it important for your business? What can happen if you don't manage your reputation? (try to find at least 2 elements)

   -

   -

3. How do you manage that online reputation? (Which tools/strategies do you need?) Give one or two examples (You can use the picts below to find inspiration).

#ChiaExplains: How to do everything in social media & digital marketing
Available online on: https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PLsrLHBOEUlPyxwThjrfUa-1j9GuBA4CiG (retrieved on 23/01/20).

Listening – On the YouTube channel of Brand24, *#ChiaExplains* **provides watchers with useful tips regarding digital marketing and social media**. Watch the three videos below and answer the questions related to each video. (NB: The questions are in the right order!). When you are ready, summarize the main ideas under the grid.

- *VID1: What is online reputation management: 2 things you need to know to do it right!*
- *VID2: 10 ways to protect your business reputation online*
- *VID3: 5 common types of bad reviews online + how to respond to them*

VIDEO 1 *https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=TqjZ9T1dV2k&t=20s*

	Questions	Circle or tick your answer.
1	In online reputation management, is it better if a company's self-perception **aligns with** how the public perceives it?	TRUE – FALSE
2	According to the video, how did reputation management happen before the Internet? Tick **all** the right answers.	Thanks to: ○ reporters & journalists ○ events ○ shops ○ networking
3	What is the best definition for "peer recommendation"?	○ traditional word of mouth ○ recommendations from a friend or relative ○ a personal experience with a brand
4	On social media, why should you address problems or negative feedback directly? Tick **all** the right answers.	○ to not jeopardize the reputation of the company ○ to prevent the issues from growing bigger ○ to show that the company reacts professionally in such a situation
5	When you have more negative reviews than positive ones on Google Search Results, you should take action and improve the situation directly.	TRUE – FALSE

Relevant information: (at least 3 elements)
- Difference in perception(s):
- Historically:
- Goal?
- How?
- 2 areas:

VIDEO 2 *https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=O9n1iwfJ24k*

	Questions	Circle or tick your answer.
1	What are Yelp, TripAdvisor or Booking?	○ critique sites ○ review sites ○ forums
2	Why is it not always possible to delete bad reviews? Tick **all** the right answers.	○ because websites offer you the opportunity to defend your business ○ because websites have different ways of working ○ because users have the right to give their opinion
3	When do customers go on blogs and forums to share their experiences? Tick **all** the right answers.	○ when they have a lot to say ○ when they do not want to be seen ○ when they had a positive impression ○ when they had a negative impression
4	A sudden increase in metrics about your business is always good news.	TRUE – FALSE
5	Bashtags are not good for a company.	TRUE – FALSE
6	Which strategy could you use in your marketing communication?	○ make a direct comparison between your company and a competing one ○ tackle a strength that a competitor does not have ○ enhance all your strengths

Relevant information:

- Monitor= ?

- Different attitudes:

- Different media:

- Figures:

VIDEO 3 *https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CLDjfMO-Pg4*

	Questions	Circle or tick your answer.
1	What are the best ways to deal with emotional reviews? Tick **all** the right answers.	○ apologies ○ silence ○ empathy ○ overreaction
2	What are the characteristics of passive reviews? Tick **all** the right answers.	○ give information about the problem ○ tell you how to fix the problem ○ show emotion ○ easy to answer to
3	It is better for a company to only have five-star reviews.	TRUE – FALSE
4	What should you do with a poor / negative biased review? Tick **all** the right answers.	○ say thank you ○ point out the bias ○ not get emotional
5	Uninformative bad reviews are not constructive and do not need to be responded to.	TRUE – FALSE
6	What is the best way to deal with dishonest bad reviews which do not provide details?	○ show the false information in their message ○ defend your business ○ tell if there is something missing in their story ○ ask what the problem was

Relevant information:

- Bad reviews: good or bad?

- Different types of bad reviews: (2-3)

- Different types of attitudes/ which are the most appropriate?

Vocabulary list

actually	**en fait, vraiment**
purchase	**achat**
online reputation	**réputation en ligne**
gap **close the gap**	**écart, fossé** **réduire l'écart**
far-off	**distant, éloigné**
public relations (PR)	**relations publiques**
focus (on sth)	**se concentrer (sur qqch)**
reach out (to sb) get in touch (with sb)	contacter quelqu'un
attend events	**assister à des événements**
networking opportunity	**opportunité/occasion de réseautage**
word of mouth	**bouche-à-oreille**
relative	**parent, membre de la famille**
peer recommendation	**recommandation par les pairs**
especially	**surtout**
keep an eye on sth	**suivre de près quelque chose**
arrive ON time	**arriver à l'heure**
evolve	**évoluer**
require	**exiger, nécessiter, demander**
pay attention to sth	**faire attention à quelque chose**
audience	**public**
address an issue	**traiter un problème**
escalate	s'intensifier
gain significance	**gagner de l'importance**
damage	**nuire à, endommager**
significance **significant**	**importance** **important**
relevant	**pertinent**
scramble	se démener
be interested in (sth / doing sth)	**s'intéresser à quelque chose**
media following	communauté médiatique
review	**critique, avis**
vent about sth	se plaindre de quelque chose
SEO ranking	classement SEO (= dans les moteurs de recherche)
pop up	surgir
improvement	**amélioration**
implement	**mettre en œuvre**
decrease	**diminuer**
look sth up	chercher quelque chose
perceive	**percevoir**
key	**clé**
foot traffic	circulation piétonne

elsewhere	**ailleurs**
lower	**baisser, diminuer**
policy	**politique (= principe, règle)**
remove	**enlever, retrirer, supprimer**
apologize **apology**	**s'excuser** **excuse**
increase	**augmentation**
find out	**découvrir, se renseigner**
set up	**installer**
sharp increase	**augmentation brusque, soudaine**
chatter	bavardage
complain about sth	**se plaindre au sujet de quelque chose**
delivery	**livraison**
package	**paquet, colis**
damaged	**endommagé**
brandjack	usurper une marque
bashtag	hashtag critique/négatif
dissatisfied	**mécontent**
CEO (Chief Executive Officer)	**Directeur Général**
PR (Public Relations) officer	**responsable des relations publiques**
competition **compete**	**concurrence** **faire concurrence**
measure up	être à la hauteur
strength	**force**
sorely	grandement
lack	**manquer de**
emphasize	**mettre en évidence, accentuer**
respond to sth **responsive**	**répondre/réagir à quelque chose** **réactif**
deal with sth	**s'occuper de, traiter de**
bound	obligé
run	**diriger**
own	**posséder**
poor review	**mauvaise critique, avis négatif**
a matter of time	une question de temps
do things by the book	faire les choses dans les règles
biased	**biaisé, partial**
uninformative	**qui n'apprend rien**
dishonest	**malhonnête**
scathingly	de manière cinglante
tricky	**difficile, délicat**
handle	**traiter, aborder, gérer**
rant	diatribe, coup de gueule
fix a problem	**régler un problème**
overreaction	réaction excessive
change somebody's mind	**changer l'opinion de quelqu'un**

sympathetic	**sympathique, compréhensif**
be entitled to	avoir le droit de
emotionally-driven	contrôlé par les émotions
pragmatic	pragmatique
prevent sth from happening	**éviter que qqch ne se passe**
rave	critique élogieuse
grin	sourire
point out	**signaler**
nuisance	**nuisance, chose/situation énervante**
cleanliness	propreté
Insight (on sth)	aperçu, idée (sur/à propos de quelque chose)
random	aléatoire
slander	calomnier, diffamer
unwarranted	injustifié

Vocabulary exercise: Choose the best answer (A, B, C, or D) to complete each sentence**.**

1. The company wants to close the _____ between what customers expect and what they actually receive. A. distance B. review C. gap D. relevance
2. Their CEO asked the PR team to improve the company's _____, because online comments were becoming increasingly negative. A. online reputation B. package C. delivery D. foot traffic
3. Many customers decided to _____ a new laptop after reading several positive reviews. A. remove B. purchase C. escalate D. decrease
4. Before launching the campaign, the team had to _____ relevant information about their audience. A. look up B. pop up

C. require D. find out
5. Influencers can be very useful, _____ when you want to reach young customers quickly. A. far-off B. especially C. elsewhere D. lower
6. The marketing manager asked everyone to _____ the situation closely to avoid another communication problem. A. keep an eye on B. damage C. vent about D. scramble
7. Local businesses often rely on _____, because personal recommendations create strong trust. A. peer recommendation B. word of mouth C. insight D. policy
8. The head of PR promised to _____ the issue before it escalates on social media. A. evolve B. address C. set up D. grin
9. The number of negative comments began to _____, so the company decided to react immediately. A. decrease B. handle C. implement D. require
10. The brand had to _____ its customer service strategy to reduce waiting time and improve satisfaction. A. compete B. implement C. be entitled to D. point out

11. A sudden _____ in website traffic suggested that something unusual had happened. A. apology B. sharp increase C. nuisance D. bashtag
12. Before writing an article, journalists often _____ facts online to verify accuracy. A. run B. look up C. slander D. complain about
13. The spokesperson tried to stay calm, even when a dissatisfied customer began to _____ emotionally. A. fix a problem B. vent about the problem C. apologize
14. When a _____ appears on a company's social media feed, it can damage credibility if not handled correctly. A. poor review B. purchase C. improvement D. insight

2. Social Media Marketing

Reading and speaking

Step 1 – Choose with your group one of those social media platforms (min 4 students per group and max.1 group per social media).

Step 2 - Social Media Marketing - Good and bad practices

1. Go and check on the Internet the good and bad practices when using your social media platform for digital marketing. Half of the students in the group search for the good practices and the other half for the bad ones. Write your findings in the table below.

Good practices (do's) (min. 6)	**Bad practices (don'ts)** (min. 6)

2. Share your findings with your group.

3. Step 3 – Analysis of a brand's social media platform

1. Choose a **company** that uses your social media platform as a marketing tool and publishes content in English.

2. Analyse the company's posts and interactions on the social media platform based on the good and bad practices you identified in step 2. Try to identify their strengths and weaknesses. Give each time concrete examples to illustrate your answer.

Strengths (with concrete examples) (min. 3)	**Weaknesses (with concrete examples)** (min. 2)

Writing

Step 4 – Email to the company

The company you chose in step 3 has hired you as a digital marketing consultant to work on the improvement of their social media platform. Write a formal e-mail of approximately 120 words in which you summarize the strengths and weaknesses of their social media platform and give some advice on how they could improve their posts and interactions on the platform.

Use complex and varied vocabulary and grammar. Pay attention to the structure of your paragraphs and make sure to use appropriate linking words.

1. Original text:

2. Corrected text:

Step 5 – Feedback on your e-mail using ChatGPT

Copy-paste your e-mail on ChatGPT (https://openai.com/blog/chatgpt/) and ask the AI to give you some feedback on your writing.

Try to use the right prompts to get relevant feedback. You can use the following evaluation grid to give you an idea on which criteria you could be evaluated.

Vocabulary	**/5**
The vocabulary is accurate in its meaning and adapted to the context of the writing.	
The vocabulary used in the writing was complex enough; there was a high proportion of business-oriented words and a low percentage of "everyday/catch-all" words.	
Grammar	**/5**
The grammar is accurate and correctly used.	
The grammar shows good knowledge and use of an upper-intermediate level (reported speech, comparisons, conditionals, etc.); the student uses various tenses.	
Syntax	**/2**
The sentences have an appropriate length, the punctuation is purposefully used and the student makes a proper use of the linking words within a paragraph. The word order is correct.	
Structure	**/5**
The text contains paragraphs, expressing each a different idea; the order in which the arguments are presented makes sense. The ideas are interconnected thanks to discourse markers and connectors.	
The student uses a communication style adapted to what is asked in the instructions.	
Content	**/3**
The text includes accurate references to the course and/or expertise on the topic. The student expresses his/her professional character with confidence.	

Feedback:

- **What are the differences between the texts?**
- **How did we use our prompts?**
- **What was better? What is still to improve?**

3. E-commerce

How E-Commerce Companies Can Compete in an Amazon-Dominated World

Adapted from: PATEL Neil (s.d.). *How E-Commerce Companies Can Compete in an Amazon-Dominated World*. Available online on: https://neilpatel.com/blog/compete-against-amazon/ (retrieved on 23/01/23).

Introduction:

1. What is E-commerce?
2. Where does E-commerce take place?
3. According to you, is it possible to compete with Amazon?

Part 1

When it comes to e-commerce marketplace dominance, Amazon is at the top of the food chain. Over 44% of all product searches begin in Amazon's search bar, and Amazon owns almost half of all U.S. online retail sales. Even some of the other biggest retail giants in the world have a tough time competing against Amazon.

So how can anyone else even compete? How do you stand a chance? Well, you don't. The simple truth of the matter is that you don't really stand a chance of competing. You won't be able to invest the time and capital it takes to build anything close to what Amazon is offering. In terms of infrastructure, scale, and sheer sales numbers, they're killing it (see Figure 1)

Figure 1

They have a massive physical footprint as well, which is only growing with their recent launch of brick-and-mortar stores around the U.S.
Some may tell you that even if you can't compete with their scale, you can compete in other ways, like offering competitive discounts and free shipping for your own customers. But in terms of product pricing, you still probably can't offer a better deal to your customers than the price they could find on Amazon. And yes, free shipping is cool. But Amazon has and will probably always have better shipping deals (see Figure 2) simply because they can afford to have better shipping deals.

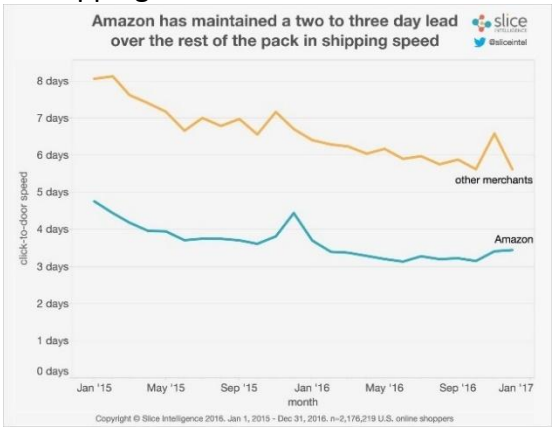


Figure 2

In these instances, you can't beat them. But there is one realm where you can live in the same relative sphere as Amazon: customer experience. Amazon has a lot of the same problems that most retailers have when dealing with customer service. They still deal with customer complaints with varying degrees of success, just like everyone else. And customer experience can play a big role in customer retention and loyalty (see *Figure 3*)

Figure 3

So, while you might not have the means and motives of the largest retailer on the Internet, you can still offer something that customers want: experience.

Reading & speaking

Read Part 1 of the text "How E-Commerce Companies Can Compete in an Amazon-Dominated World" and answer the following questions **in pairs**:

1. Why is it difficult to compete with Amazon? Look at the facts and figures.

2. According to the author of the text, is it possible to beat Amazon in E-commerce?

3. What do you think about the author's statements? Do you agree or not?

4. Do you already have ideas of strategies companies could implement to be successful in the e-commerce market despite Amazon's dominance?

Challenge: How to compete with Amazon?

Part 2

Here are a few ways to offer a comparable customer experience to Amazon's without breaking the bank.

1. **Create a solid product offering for your niche**

As Neil Irwin once pointed out, Amazon has a "winner-takes-all" approach to sales. They want to sell every product in every category. If you think about it, their "niche" is really a lack of a niche. They sell to everyone. But you can't do that. You simply can't appeal to the wide audience that Amazon does with their vast selection of products. So, what can you do instead? Do just the opposite: sell within a niche.

Just like you can't appeal to the wide audience that Amazon markets to, Amazon can't satisfy every need in every niche. That's where you have an opportunity to fill in the gaps.

If you already have a decent product offering and audience, start with what you have. Look at your existing products and find a way to fit them into a narrower niche. This might mean that you focus on curating products that meet customer demands rather than trying to be ultra-competitive on product pricing. Studies show that after customer experience, the second biggest reason a customer will leave is dissatisfaction with the product itself (see Figure 4).

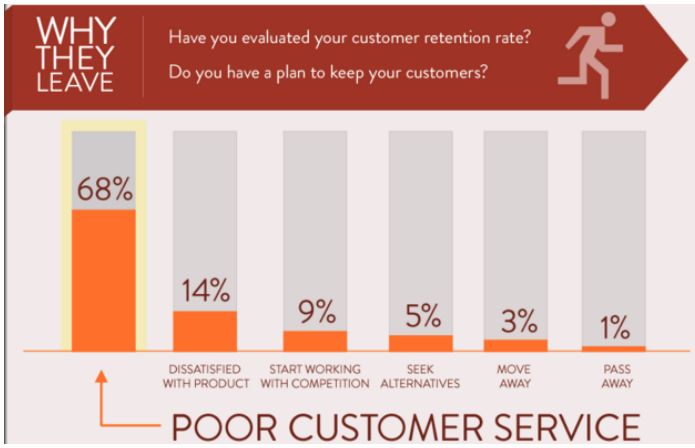


Figure 4

You can save yourself a few headaches by putting some extra effort into marketing and promoting your products and making sure they work for your audience.

But don't be afraid to look for other smaller product categories and niches that might serve your audience, too.

The other way that you can go about niching is by using Amazon's categories to find smaller, profitable niches that fit well with a current customer base and product line.

If you go to Amazon, you can find hundreds of niche ideas on their site directory (see Figure 5).

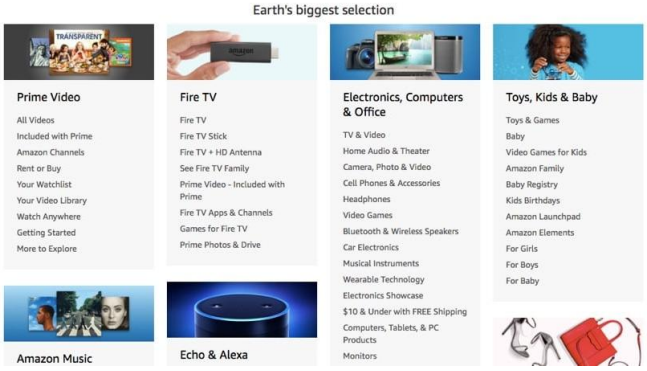


Figure 5

Clicking on any product category (see Figure 6) will also give you a list of dozens more niche and category ideas.

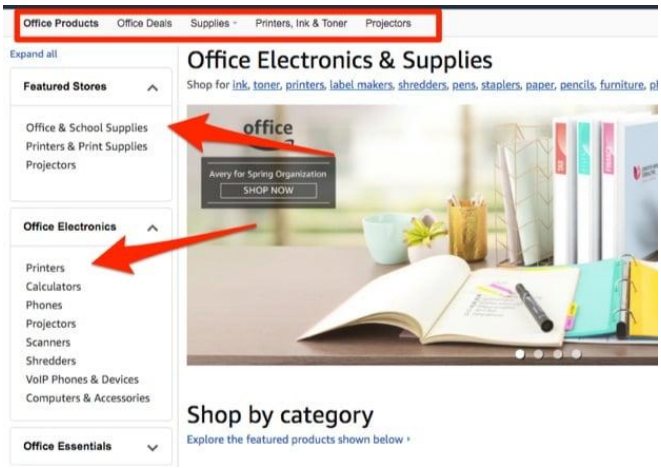


Figure 6

This will give you a better idea of the types of products your customers may want from your brand. When you can tailor the shopping experience to their specific tastes, you can "compete" with Amazon because you're giving them what they want in a one-stop shop: your site.

2. Use customer data to inform your business

Amazon collects data on every single customer of their 300 million customers.
They collect information on all kinds of things: browsing details (IP addresses, operating system, etc.), search queries, wish lists, reviews and previous order history, and other datasets.

They do this to inform a lot of their marketing strategies and determine how to best serve their customers in other ways.
Some of the things they use customer data for include:

- Product recommendations based on previous searches, wish lists, and order history
- Kindle book recommendations based on data from Goodreads
- One-click ordering based on user profiles
- Anticipatory shipping (their patented model) based on user profiles
- Supply chain optimization based on customer locations (user profiles)
- Product pricing optimization based on search inquiries and competitive data
- Cloud storage optimization (Amazon Web Services) based on user data

A former Amazon employee once said that Amazon *"has the ability to track both what people are buying as well as what they search for and can't find."*

This is part of what gives them the edge over competitors in a lot of ways.
But you can also use customer and competitive data to help improve your offerings in the same way that Amazon does.
One retailer, Spearmint LOVE, saw a year-over-year growth of 991% when they started using their customer data to create more targeted Facebook Ads, for example.

They were also able to use dynamic product ads to retarget shoppers who had visited their site, improving their reach by simply using basic data you can easily gather from Google Analytics.
According to research cited by McKinsey, companies that use customer data to inform their practices see 85% more sales and 25% more gross margins than those that ignore their data.
You can use the behavioral data you already have in your database (customer profiles and shopping history, etc.) to improve key areas of customer acquisition and retention.

Customer Acquisition	Customer Retention and Growth
Improve rate of customer acquisition	Improve retention/lower churn
Lower cost of customer acquisition	Increase repeat purchases
Increase conversion rates	Increase cross-sell, up-sell
Increase velocity to purchase	Decrease cost of service
Increase purchase sizes	Improve customer satisfaction and loyalty
Improve marketing ROI	Increase lifetime value

Just because you can't shell out hundreds of thousands of dollars to acquire data like Amazon does, it doesn't mean you can't use the same strategies they use to propel your business forward. It's a matter of using the resources you do have to improve your offerings.

3. Consider adding subscription services

Convenience is something Amazon offers in abundance. They do this by offering subscription services like Subscribe and Save (see Figure 7) , which offers customers the chance to receive specific products automatically every month.

Figure 7

An Amazon Prime membership also comes with some convenience perks like free two-day shipping and unlimited streaming and use of Amazon's other services.

They now also offer Amazon Payments, which gives customers the additional convenience of being able to purchase items from other retailers using an Amazon account. (Amazon also tracks these purchases to fuel their data even further, of course.)

Adding something like a subscription service not only provides convenience for customers, but it also can help your own revenue.
Research shows that businesses with subscriptions increase revenue twice as fast as their competitors and see 2x the overall growth.
To take advantage of a subscription model like Amazon's and consider offering renewable subscriptions for certain products that are likely to be repeat purchases.
Or, if few of your products lend themselves to repeat purchases, consider offering a curated box of specific items every month (the subscription box model) like Birchbox (see Figure 8) and Dollar Shave Club (see Figure 9).

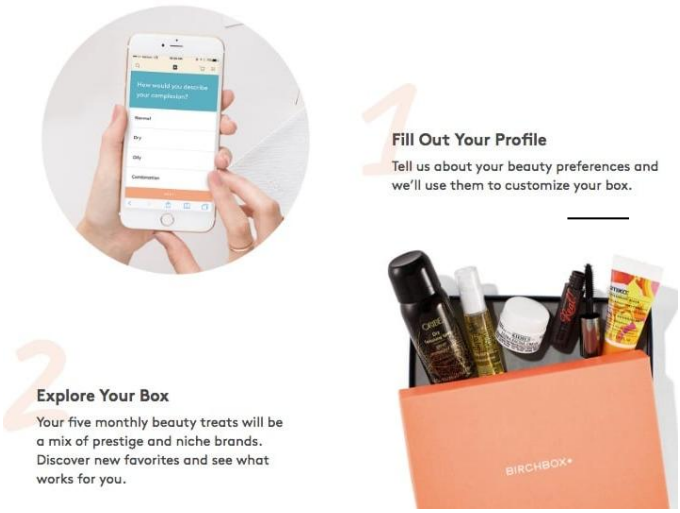


Figure 8

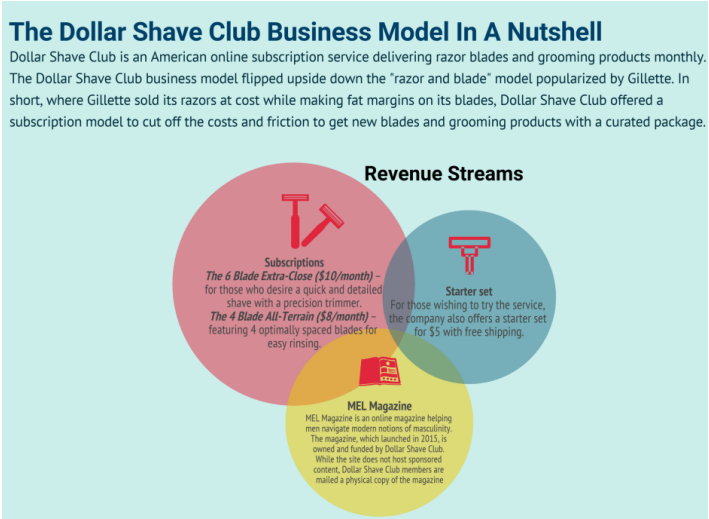


Figure 9

Other ideas might include:

- Subscription-based shipping plans
- Offers from specific manufacturers
- Product discounts for membership

This not only sets you up for more sales in the long run, but it also gives customers a chance to get products from you without sacrificing their convenience.

4. Improve your shipping

Now, you can't directly *compete* with Amazon when it comes to shipping. Technically, not even Amazon fulfillment can compete with Amazon.

According to GeekWire, Amazon lost $7.2 billion from shipping in 2017 between what it cost them and what they charged. But they have more than enough revenue from other sources to make up for it. You probably don't. The goal isn't to compete, anyway. Your goal is to stay in the game. To do that, there are plenty of ways you can improve your shipping to provide additional convenience and customer service.

First up, consider offering free or discounted shipping for a minimum threshold or for specific products.

For example, REI offers free shipping on purchases over $50, but they include other caveats to the rule that allow them to maintain this offer without losing money (see Figure 10)

For example, the offer isn't valid for special orders or prior purchases.

Studies show that 48% of shoppers on average will add items to their carts if it means that they can qualify for free shipping. So, while it might come with some initial costs for you, you're more likely to see a return on investment (ROI) in added purchases.

If you have specific products that are lightweight (cost effective to ship, for example), you can offer free shipping on ground delivery orders.

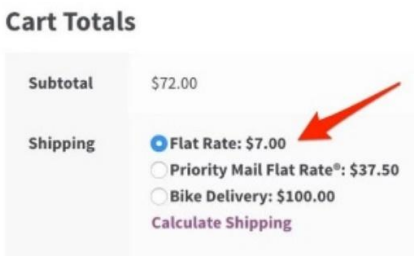
Most carriers have slower, low-cost shipping options. USPS parcel post, for instance, is typically cheaper than priority mail, so you'll spend less.

Customers then have the option to pay to upgrade. But when they do they know it's a choice rather than a requirement, so they're less likely to be dissatisfied.

If you're really in a bind financially but want to deliver products for no cost, you do have the option of including those shipping costs in the retail cost of the product.

Of course, you will have to tread carefully with this idea, as your product might appear less favorable on price comparison sites due to the markup.

Another option is to simply offer flat rates for your shipping.



While it's not free, it still offers customers cheaper shipping for varying products and encourages them to purchase more. If they'll pay the same shipping price for one item as they would for ten items, then why not just get ten products, right?

Free U.S. standard shipping on orders of $50 or more.

- Oversized shipping charges for any heavy or large items will be applied. These oversized shipping charges will be reflected at checkout.
- Offer valid only on orders placed at REI.com, REI Garage and 1-800-426-4840.
- To order by phone, call 1-800-426-4840 Mon-Fri, 5am through 10pm and Sat-Sun, 6am through 9pm PT.
- Offer not valid on return shipments, special orders, prior purchases, REI gift cards or e-gift cards, gift boxes, memberships, shop services, rentals.
- Offer is limited to stock on hand and backorderable items, is nontransferable and is not redeemable for cash.
- Offer limited to standard shipping to U.S. addresses only (including APOs and FPOs).

Figure 10

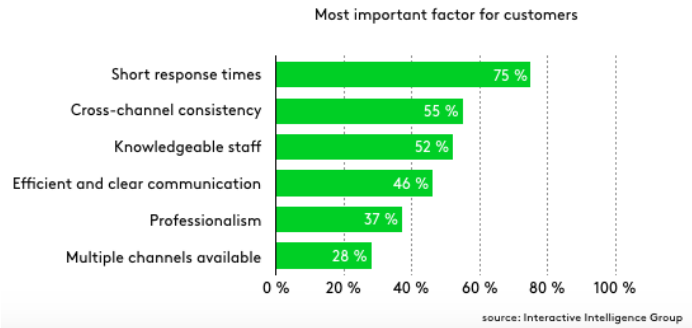
5. Make an effort with customer service

Finally, and perhaps most importantly, the best way you can stay on par with Amazon is by offering outstanding customer service.
Amazon actually does fairly well at this. 67% of respondents to Amazon's customer service report last year indicated that they were "very satisfied."

But what exactly makes customer service satisfying for the majority of consumers?
According to research by GetApp Lab (see Figure 11), the most valuable component of good customer service is simply a real, knowledgeable human on the other end of the line.

Figure 11

However, the study showed that it didn't really matter if the customer service was offered through email, a phone call, or a chat service. When the rep was perceived to be real (or the correspondence was personalized enough), customers were happier with the results.
So, what does this mean for your customer service?
This means putting real people in charge of your customer service. If you already have a team of people who handle customer complaints, you can add automation to shorten response times.



If you don't have a large team of people who handle customer service requests, you can always outsource the job using a customer service software or apps like LiveChat or Desk.com.
While it is a bit of an extra cost (though some services are free depending on your usage and the size of your company), it's well worth it in terms of customer loyalty.
There are plenty of other ways that you can make sure you have responsive service, however.
You can set up automatic replies on social media or use notifications to alert you when customers ask questions over social media.
If you're responsive enough, Facebook will actually tell customers how soon you typically reply to messages sent via Facebook Messenger.
The more active you are, the more customers will tend to trust you. And automation cuts down on the time and energy for your customer service team.
You can also include SMS text updates or responses for mobile customers.
Whichever technology you choose, just make sure you're keeping the human element alive.
Even when customer service reps can't resolve an issue, responsiveness and friendliness will still improve your customer service rating.

Even when you can't compete with Amazon for things like competitive prices or shipping, you can always go above and beyond with customer service to set yourself up as a worthy alternative.
Who knows? At the end of the day, customers might prefer your store over Amazon simply due to your outstanding customer service.
That's the goal, anyway.

Part 2 of the text "How E-Commerce Companies Can Compete in an Amazon-Dominated World"

- **Step 1:** form groups (5 students)**.**
- **Step 2:** each student in the group reads 1 or 2 tips from Part 2 of the text (depending on the number of students in the group) and summarizes their text section(s) in their own words (**i.e. Answer minimum 2 important questions per §)**.

- **Step 3:** each student shares their summary with the other students in the group.
- **Step 4:** as a group, what do you consider the best tips for a future online retailer? Give a score from 1 to 5 (1 being very advantageous) and justify your choices (**use the modals).**

Tip	Score	Justification
1. Create a solid product offering for your niche		
2. Use customer data to inform your business		
3. Consider adding subscription services		
4. Improve your shipping		
5. Make an effort with customer service		

FEEDBACK: compare with the other groups

Vocabulary - Find in the text the words corresponding to the following translations or definitions:

Translation / definition	Word(s) from the text
Rentable	_____
A company's ability to turn customers into repeat buyers and prevent them from switching to a competitor	Customer _____
Des publicités ciblées	_____ adverts
Un abonnement	_____
Synonym of « buy »	To _____
Synonym of « delivery »	s_____ costs
Une demande d'un client Une réclamation d'un client	Customer r_____ Customer _____
The sum of all the expenses involved in the course of handling product from receiving to distribution. These costs can include: receiving, segregating and storing the product., picking, packing and shipping.	F_____ costs

Vocabulary list

retail	**commerce de détail**
be based on	**être basé sur**
competitor	**concurrent**
footprint	empreinte
discount	**remise, réduction**
afford	**avoir les moyens, pouvoir se permettre**
customer experience	**expérience client**
complaint	**plainte**
customer retention	**fidélisation de la clientèle**
customer loyalty	**fidélité des clients**
product offering	**offre de produits**
appeal to	**plaire à**
wide audience	**large public**
decent	**convenable**
meet customer demands	**répondre aux demandes des clients**

tailor	**personnaliser**
dataset	ensemble de données
inform marketing strategies	**adapter/élaborer des stratégies marketing**
patented	breveté
supply chain	**chaîne d'approvisionnement**
give the edge over	donner l'avantage sur
wish list	**liste de souhaits**
targeted	**ciblé**
gross margin	marge brute
customer acquisition	**acquisition de la clientèle**
shell out	payer
perk	**avantage**
item	**article**
curated box	boîte personnalisée
fulfillment	**The process of storing, packing, and shipping orders, as well as handling returns and exchanges.**
charge	**facturer, faire payer**
make up for	**compenser**
minimum threshold	**seuil minimum**
caveat	**réserve, restriction**
cart	**panier (en ligne), chariot (de courses)**
return on investment (ROI)	**retour sur investissement**
lightweight	léger
cost effective **cost effectiveness**	**rentable** **rentabilité**
ground delivery	**livraison par voie terrestre**
carrier	**transporteur**
in a bind	dans le pétrin
markup	augmentation de prix
flat rate	**tarif fixe/forfaitaire**
valuable	**important, appréciable**
shorten response time	**réduire/diminuer le temps de réponse**
request	**demande**
responsive	**réactif**
automatic replies	**réponses automatiques**
trust	**faire confiance**
resolve an issue	**résoudre un problème**
rating	**évaluation**
be involved in	**être impliqué dans**
beyond	**au-delà**

4. Inside Amazon's Smart Warehouse

Extracts from: Tech Vision (2020). *Inside Amazon's Smart Warehouse.* Available online on: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=IMPbKVb8y8s (retrieved on 26/01/23).

Vocabulary – Match the words with their corresponding definition / translation.

To ferry •	• une supposition / hypothèse
Assumption •	• a building that stores products for stocking, packing, and shipping preparation
Warehouse / fulfillment center •	• un poste de travail fixe
Mile •	• to transport people or goods in a vehicle, especially regularly and often
Pod •	• contenir / garder du stock
Stationary workstation •	• a unit of distance in English-speaking countries equal to approximately 1.6 kilometres
Substitution •	• le remplacement
To hold stock •	• récupérer du stock
To retrieve stock •	• shelving unit = une étagère

Listening - Watch the video and answer the following questions.

1. What has led Amazon to become the world's biggest retailer and its CEO Jeff Bezos the richest man?

2. What is "Deep learning AI"? What is it used for at Amazon?

3. Is the following statement true or false? Justify your answer.
   Nowadays employees in Amazon fulfilment centres walk about 12 miles per shift to pick up items.

4. What is Kiva system? What is the link between this company and Amazon?

5. How does the substitution of the robots in place of human workers make a colossal difference to amazon's bottom line? Give as many numbers as possible in your answer.

Vocabulary list

assumption	**hypothèse, supposition**
mile	**mile (+-1.6 km)**
pod	**module**
stationary workstation	**poste de travail fixe**
substitution	**remplacement**
hold stock	**détenir du stock**
retrieve stock	**récupérer du stock**
goods	**marchandises**
vehicle	**véhicule**
shelving unit	**étagère**
lightning fast	ultra-rapide
delivery time	**temps de livraison**
ferry	transporter
inside 24 hours	en/dans les 24 heures
ingenious	ingénieux
unscrupulous	sans scrupules
deep learning AI	intelligence artificielle d'apprentissage profond
warehouse / fulfillment center	**entrepôt**
shift	**quart de travail, équipe (de jour/de nuit)**
executive	cadre (supérieur)
fulfillment centers	centres de distribution
sortation centers	centres de tri
flagship model	modèle phare
conveyor belt	tapis roulant
sensor	**capteur**
lean and mean	efficace et performant
stow	ranger
sack	licencier
challenging	**difficile / exigeant**
incentive scheme	programme de primes
in-house	interne
merch	**produits dérivés**

5. The importance of Internet in business – e-commerce & digital marketing

Advantages of Using the Internet for Business

HENDERSON, K.J. (s.d.). *Advantages of Using the Internet for Business*. Available online on: http://smallbusiness.chron.com/advantages-using-internet-business-320.html (retrieved on 05/03/17).

The advent of the Internet has in many ways leveled the playing field for small businesses to compete with major corporations. The Internet has allowed fledgling businesses to increase both visibility and revenue, reaching a potential customer population never before seen in history. An owner who understands the benefits of utilizing the Internet when conducting business and applies the practices can maximize the potential of his organization.

Potential Customer Base

Not too long ago, if a person started a business, she might place a few advertisements locally in the hopes of building a name for herself in the area. The Internet has changed that practice completely. An Internet presence instantly gives her company a global audience. Customers from around the world are able to learn about and purchase her products and services. Her potential population of customers is endless.

A Store that Never Closes

The World Wide Web operates 24 hours a day, seven days a week. Businesses that sell ready-made products benefit most from this advantage. By creating an Internet store, these entrepreneurs have the ability to maintain a virtual retail shop that never closes, affording the owner the possibility of literally making money in his sleep.

Networking Opportunities

The Internet has created a global community of peers. In the past, a business owner's only option was to join a local chamber of commerce in order to network and learn from fellow entrepreneurs. The creation of chat rooms and Internet forums, however, has taken the idea of fellowship to a new level. A person in Portland, Maine, now can exchange advice regarding marketing and promotional techniques with someone in the same line of business based in Sydney, Australia.

Cost Effective

Perhaps the biggest advantage of using the Internet for business is its cost effectiveness. Opening and maintaining an online store costs a fraction of the budget required to open a physical shop. Advertising online is less expensive than in traditional media, and it allows business owners to reach a more targeted demographic. The Internet also allows business to be conducted without expensive travel. In the retail industry, for example, a shop owner can browse and purchase goods for resale from suppliers around the globe without having to leave the comfort of his computer desk.

Reading – Read the text on the previous page. What are the advantages of using the Internet in business as presented in the article? Explain them in English.

Speaking – In pairs, can you think of other advantages and disadvantages of using Internet, e-commerce and digital marketing in business? Explain.

	Advantages	**Disadvantages**
Internet		
E-commerce		
Digital marketing		

Vocabulary list

advent	**avènement**
level the playing field	niveler les règles du jeu, redistribuer les cartes
fledgling	débutant
reach customers	**atteindre les clients**
utilize	**utiliser**
build a name	**se faire un nom**
global	**mondial**
endless	**sans limite**
ready-made product	**produit tout fait/prêt**
maintain	**maintenir**
fellow	**compagnon, collègue**
fellowship	**camaraderie, confrerie**
demographic	**population**

6. Writings:

Situation 1 : **«** *Une entreprise confrontée à des avis négatifs en ligne* »

Contexte :
Tu es le **responsable marketing digital** d'un petit détaillant en ligne qui a récemment reçu plusieurs **avis négatifs** sur Google et sur les réseaux sociaux. Certains clients se sont plaints de **colis endommagés**, de **livraisons en retard** et d'un **service client insuffisant**. En conséquence, votre **réputation en ligne** s'est dégradée et votre **référencement (SEO)** a chuté.

Tâche : Rédige un court texte de 55 à 75 mots dans lequel tu abordes au minimum deux points parmi ceux-ci dessous :

- Ce que l'entreprise devrait faire pour **améliorer sa réputation en ligne**,
- Comment elle pourrait **répondre aux avis négatifs**,
- Quelles **stratégies de marketing digital** (ex : bouche-à-oreille, recommandations de pairs, contenu sur les réseaux sociaux) pourraient aider à reconstruire la confiance,
- Comment des outils de veille ou une **gestion de la réputation en ligne** pourraient soutenir ces efforts.

Vocabulaire : Utilise et souligne minimum 3 mots parmi ceux ci-dessous
Review, customer service, respond to, online reputation, complaints, improve, monitor, feedback, digital marketing, brand image, relevant content, followers, trust.

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Situation 2 : "*Conseils à un ami sur le lacement et la promotion de son entreprise* »

Situation : Ton ami veut lancer une petite entreprise d'e-commerce (produits aux choix). Néanmoins, le marché est hyperconcurrentiel et dominé par Amazon et il demande ton expertise pour se démarquer tant au niveau de la gestion de son entreprise que dans la promotion de ses produits.

Tâche : Rédige un texte d'environ 55 à 75 mots dans lequel tu :

- mentionnes ce qui **est essentiel** pour toi lors du lancement d'une entreprise d'e-commerce),
- donnes **quelques arguments (2-3**) qui te permettent de **faire fonctionner** ton e-commerce face à Amazon et à la concurrence.
- expliques ce qui **peut te différencier** des autres au niveau promotionnel (2-3 arguments).

Vocabulaire : Utilise et souligne minimum 3 mots parmi ceux ci-dessous :
Online reputation, reach, targeted audience, review, customer experience, brand image, digital marketing, relevant content, purchase, trust, followers, feedback.

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Talking about the Pros and Cons in English[1]

Pros	Cons
One/A Benefit One/An Upside to ….. is One/An Advantage One/A Good side One/a Plus The greatest advantage/ The main advantage/ The most significant advantage One point in favor of/in support of An argument in favor of One reason to be in favor of/in support of (note difference between this and the next) Arguments for/ Supporting arguments/ …. is better/more suitable/more effective	One/A Drawback One/A Downside One/A Disadvantage One/A Bad side One/ A Minus One criticism I have is… An argument against this is… One reason to not be in favor of/in support of (note difference between this and the next) One reason I'm not in favor of/ in support of
Linking words to show contrast	
But However Although Whereas On the contrary, On the one hand / on the other hand	

[1] https://www.speakconfidentenglish.com/pros-and-cons-english/

7. Vocabulary exercise

Translate the following sentences into English.

1. L'entreprise a pour but de restreindre l'accès du personnel à Internet car elle a rencontré énormément de problèmes de piratage ces derniers mois.

2. Il est nécessaire de comprendre l'impact de la stratégie digitale sur les ventes hors-lignes afin de savoir comment investir dans ce domaine à l'avenir.

3. Il a contribué de manière significative à la gestion de la réputation en ligne de la firme en postant du contenu de haute qualité sur des réseaux sociaux tels que Facebook ou Twitter.

4. Google dispose de sa propre politique de respect de la vie privée de manière à ce que les données personnelles des clients soient rassemblées et protégées contre toute attaque malveillante.

5. L'entreprise aide également ses clients à se protéger grâce à une large gamme de services de sécurité tels que des pares-feux ou des logiciels antivirus. Ainsi, elle empêche les pirates d'accéder aux données privées des utilisateurs.

8. Grammar focus: modal auxiliaries[2]

Modals	Meanings	Examples
CAN **(neg. CANNOT/CAN'T)**	- (im)possibility -(un)ability -permission or refusal - polite request	*When the weather is clear, you can see the coast.* *I'm afraid I can't come to your party.* *Can you speak any foreign languages?* *They can't understand our problem.* *Can I stay until midnight?* *You can't have the car on Saturday night.* *Can you give me a hand?*
BE ABLE TO **(neg. CANNOT/ CAN'T)**	- (un)ability	*Are you able to spot the difference between the two?*
COULD **(neg. COULD NOT/COULDN'T)**	- general or permanent ability in the past (>< BE ABLE TO) - perception in the past - asking for permission - making suggestions about the future - polite request	*He could walk at the age of 10 months.* *When she walked into the house, she could smell something burning.* *Could I use the bathroom?* *We could go and see a movie tonight.* *Could you give me a hand?*
WAS ABLE TO **(neg. COULD NOT/COULDN'T)**	- particular or temporary situations in the past (>< COULD)	*They were able to climb to the top of the mountain before the storm broke out.*
MUST **(neg. MUST NOT/MUSTN'T)**	- obligation/necessity to do sth (// HAVE TO) - logical deduction - (neg.) forbidden to do sth	*You must be on time for your appointment.* *You must be eighteen to have a driving license.* *You must be Dr Livingston.* *You mustn't use your mobile phone during the concert.*
HAVE TO **(neg. MUST NOT/MUSTN'T/DON'T**	- obligation/necessity to do sth (// MUST)	*You have to be on time for your appointment.*

[2] Based on: http://sites.uclouvain.be/gramlink/Gramlink-AN/grammaire/auxiliaires.htm (retrieved on 13/03/17).

HAVE TO)	- (neg.) not necessary to do sth	*You don't have to call him; he already knows about the meeting.*
HAD TO (neg. DIDN'T HAVE TO)	- see MUST & HAVE TO (but in the past)	*They had to call a doctor in the middle of the night.*
SHOULD (neg. SHOULD NOT/SHOULDN'T)	- piece of advice - moral recommendation - personal opinion - assumption	*You should read this book, it's really entertaining.* *Nick should stop smoking.* *Adults should work; children should study and play.* *Why don't we give him a call? He should be at home.*
OUGHT TO (neg. OUGHT NOT TO/OUGHTN'T TO)	- (// SHOULD but more formal)	*You ought to stop smoking.*
MAY (neg. MAY NOT)	- possibility (// MIGHT) - permission	*I'll ask him. He may know.* *May I borrow your car on Saturday?*
MIGHT (neg. MIGHT NOT)	- possibility (// MAY)	*I'll ask him. He might know.*
SHALL	- instructions or suggestions	*Shall I take your coat?*
WILL	- polite request - invitation	*Will you do me a favor?* *Will you join for a drink?*
WOULD (neg. WOULD NOT/WOULDN'T)	- polite request - repeated actions in the past	*Would you close the door please?* *Every Sunday afternoon she would go to the swimming pool.*
USED TO (neg. DIDN'T USE TO)	- repeated states or actions in the past	*I used to smoke twenty cigarettes a day.*

Exercises

Complete with the correct modal auxiliary and the correct form/tense of the verb.

1. He …… at the airport this afternoon. He was with me in town. (be)
2. When you are in the army, you …… what your sergeant tells you. (do)
3. The teacher …… in class 5 minutes before his students, so he hurried up with his preceding class. (be)
4. He …… adjusting the aerial if he's not getting a good picture on his new TV set. (try)
5. I knew what to do. You …… me three times. (tell)
6. Tom …… at school today. I didn't see him there. (be)
7. I …… my mother what happened. She already knew. (tell)
8. Sorry man! I …… . See you next week. (go)
9. You …… that shirt. It's not dirty. (wash)
10. You ……a little bit after all that strenuous exercise. (rest)

Choose the right option(s).

1. Judging by the state of the children's bedroom, there **might be/may be/might have been/has to be** a riot in it.
2. It isn't cold outside. You **can't/have to/mustn't/don't have to** wear a coat.
3. You **can/have to/don't need/aren't allowed to** vote in Britain until you are 18.
4. Tomorrow is a holiday. We **have to/mustn't/aren't allowed to/don't have to** go to work.
5. You **must/can't/don't have to/ought to** ride a bicycle on a motorway in Britain.
6. I'm not sure, but I **may have seen/can't have seen/must have seen/can see** Sue in town last night.
7. My letter **may arrive/must have arrived/can't have arrived/should have arrived** yesterday, but it didn't.
8. I can hear footsteps in the flat upstairs, so there **may/must/can't/mustn't** be someone there.

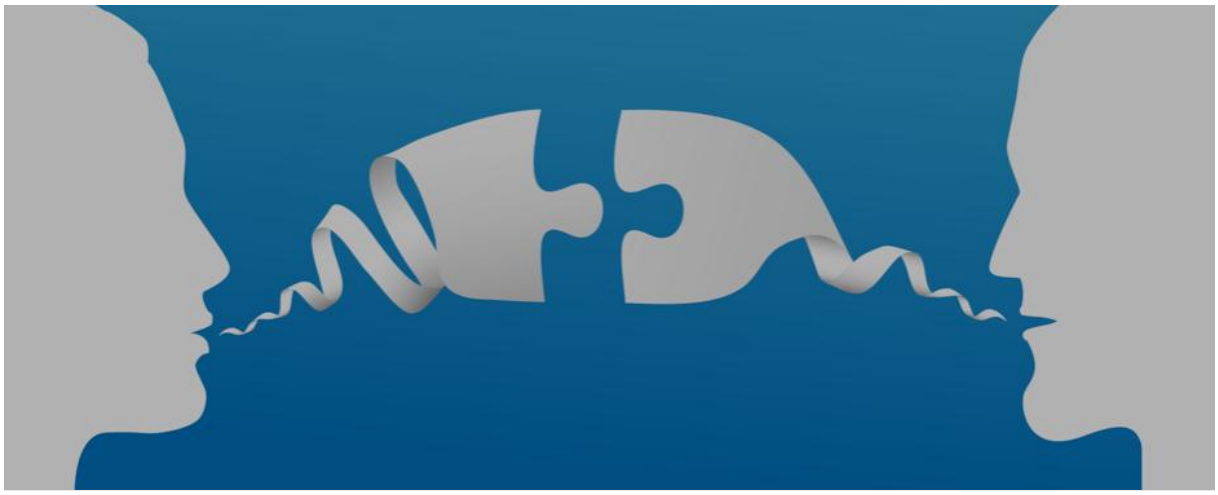
9. Developing your conversational skills: fluency and responsiveness

During some group conversations, we have observed that students take their turn to say the "bit" that they have prepared but there is little **interaction** between the participants or **reaction** to what others have said.

We would like to help you become **more responsive in group discussions** and debates. Below is a list which will equip you with **words, phrases and sentences** you can use to react to and build on what someone else has said. These expressions will create more **flow** in your conversations and your debates.

How?

Think about when you speak to someone (on the phone or face to face): you don't just listen passively, do you? You acknowledge what you hear by uttering little interjections like *"huh huh… ah… hmm?... really?… yes… oh Wow"*. You do this without thinking and it shows the others that you are listening to them. It creates what we call **rapport** between you and your colleagues: an unconscious bond of trust, respect and understanding you form with the person you speak with. And it can happen whether you agree with them or not.



https://youmustlearnnlp.com/comm/420/

You also express **emotions** caused within you by what you are hearing: amazement, agreement, or disbelief, even anger… and your **intonation** (and often your facial expression) reflects how you feel

You do this very naturally in your own mother language, but it needs to be learned and drilled in a foreign language (unless you live in the country and just pick it up by immersion in the target language!).

Of course, you don't need to know the whole list: **choose a few phrases** but **practise** them as often as you can; try and "place" them in conversation. It will not feel natural to start with, but as you **repeat** them over and over, it will become more comfortable. So, persevere as *"practice makes perfect!"*

AGREEMENT, ACKNOWLEDGEMENT, AMAZEMENT

Statement 1 by one of the speakers: *"More than 50% of businesses are out of touch with their younger customers because they don't advertise on social media"*

Oh really? Wow! You read that?
I didn't know that.
That sounds interesting… crazy… ridiculous!
That's amazing! That's unbelievable!
I never realized that until you mentioned it.
Thanks for sharing that.

Statement 2 of one of the speakers: *"Many small businesses fail because they have a hard time adapting to the ever-evolving digital technology."*

I can imagine…
Of course, that makes sense.
I was just going to say that!
My point exactly!
I agree! I completely agree!
We're on the same page!

DISAGREEMENT, DISBELIEF, CONTRAST

Statement 1 of one of the speakers: *"More than 50% of businesses are out of touch with their younger customers because they don't advertise on social media"*

Are you sure? I've never heard that!
It doesn't make sense.
I find that hard to believe.
Maybe but there must be more to it, don't you think?

Statement 2 of one of the speakers: *"Many small businesses fail because they have a hard time adapting to the ever-evolving digital technology."*

I don't agree! I strongly disagree!
I respect your opinion, but I see it differently: in my understanding…
I am unsure about that.